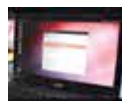




Minecraft VR

Minecraft will be playable in VR on Windows with the Oculus Rift say Mojang.
<http://dgit.in/minecvr>



Linux on Chromebook

Interested in learning how to run Linux on a Chromebook? Here's how
<http://dgit.in/linuxcb>

Science fairs, motivational talks, year long vacations and much more

Google's 80-20 doctrine

One of the most interesting ways Google promotes innovation is by letting its employees spend 20% of their salaried time working on their personal projects. The concept of letting your employees spend their time pursuing their projects of passion, not only inspires creativity and productivity, but has also given birth to a number of projects which have gone ahead to become highly successful products. Started off by 3M, the multinational company behind 'Post it' notes, the 80-20 concept became a part of Google culture eventually.

Many great Google products have originated in this 20% time including Gmail and AdSense. Both services were being worked on and developed by Google employees in their 'Personal- Time' and went on to become some of the most successful Google products ever created. The success of 20% doctrine led to a trend in various tech business around the globe. Many companies, including Yahoo!, Conde Nast, Flickr and The Huffington Post have started experimenting with the concept.

Keep your employees motivated- Google talks

To constantly keep its employees motivated, Google regularly organises on-campus 'Google talks' for everyone. A concept similar to that of TED talks, famous and eminent personalities from all walks of lives are invited to Googleplex to give a talk to its employees. The long list of speakers include names of celebrities like Lady Gaga, Tina Fey and many others famous artists, activists, technologists, and politicians.

The main aim of these talks, as Google puts it, is to keep its employees brains, "learning, growing and thinking".



The super secret Google X labs was recently renamed to 'X'

Microsoft's 'Science Fair'- For the kid in you

Remember making that volcano model for your school science fair and how much fun you had while doing it? Competitions not only test your skills and talent, but also force you to be creative and innovate. Keeping this spirit alive, twice a year, Microsoft

organizes 'Science fair' on its campus. Normally conducted in 'The Garage', these fair are attended by almost everyone, from the company founder to various project managers, acting as a platform for the employee's to showcase their creativity and skills. And if you are still thinking that's not cool enough, the winner gets to blow a giant sized volcano. Yes your read it right. So who wants to work for Microsoft.

King/Queen Dev of the month- Github

One of the most used and famous web-based Git repository services, Github, uses a very smart idea to improve itself. Every month, the best developer is selected and crowned the King/Queen dev of the month. This person gets to man the helpdesk for a day, getting him direct feedback from the customers, and giving him a chance to understand and fix the problems quickly.

Swap your team-HubSpot

A company founded by 2 MIT graduates, HubSpot offers a software product of the same name that provides with various tools of inbound marketing including, social media marketing, content management and web analytics. The company also has a very startup-isque culture and is known to take care of its employees. The company regularly organises talks by eminent personalities from various fields, just like Google talks, for its employees. Also, an employee can temporarily shift to any division to experience a new domain. For Ex, a product engineer can sit in marketing meetings and join the department for a while.

A year long sabbatical- Sagmeister & Walsh

At some point of time, we all become tired of what we are doing and wish if we could go on a long vacation, probably a year long one. But how practical is that? You need to go to work, earn money and do other mundane but unavoidable things. But not always.

Sagmeister & Walsh is one of the most famous design firms in New York. The company's founder, designer Stefan Sagmeister, gives all his employees a year off after every seven years. According to Stefan, after the year long vacation he and his team comes back more rejuvenated, inspired and with a clearer vision. For all those interested, their next year long holiday is scheduled for the year 2017.

Dogs

A recent study conducted at Claremont Graduate University, California showed that bringing your dog to your workplace leads to an increased productivity, lower stress levels and increased creativity. Google is a company that started the trend of 'Bring your Pet to work' day which has been slowly adopted by others. Going a



Playing with a dog reduces stress, and helps boost your mood and creativity.

step forward, the company recently updated its code of conduct to make it more dog friendly, officially adding the line "Google's affection for our canine friends is an integral facet of our corporate culture". If this wasn't enough, there exists a group of dog loving Google employees called 'Dooglers', and a dog themed cafe, where you can sit with your canine friend and let your creative juices flow. 